

RivalPulse

AI Competitive Intelligence Agent for Indonesian Companies

Hackathon Track: AI Agents & Assistants

ONE-LINE IDEA

RivalPulse monitors competitors, combines public competitive signals with Sectors financial data, and uses an AI agent to explain not only what changed - but why it may matter to marketing and strategy teams.

Prepared for a 4-person team

Purpose: team alignment, MVP planning, problem validation, and hackathon pitch preparation

1. Executive Summary

The problem: competitive intelligence is important but rarely urgent. Marketers repeatedly describe a workflow built from spreadsheets, alerts, competitor websites, social accounts, pricing pages and manual checks. The result is fragmented information, hours of recurring work, missed changes and difficulty turning raw observations into strategy.

The opportunity: most monitoring tools focus on detecting that something changed. RivalPulse focuses on a harder question: **what does that change mean when viewed together with the competitor's underlying business performance?**

The product: a purpose-built AI competitive-intelligence agent for Indonesian public companies. It tracks selected competitors, pulls verified financial context from Sectors, combines that context with relevant public signals, stores state over time, and produces evidence-backed strategic alerts for marketing and strategy teams.

REAL PAIN	SECTORS-CORE	AGENTIC
Manual monitoring is tedious, inconsistent and easy to neglect.	Financial context is not decorative; it is required to explain competitor momentum.	The system plans research, calls tools, compares state, filters signals and explains impact.

Hackathon fit

- Track 01 requires a mandatory AI/LLM component plus custom-built agent logic or orchestration.
- Qualifying patterns include multi-step reasoning, custom tool-use pipelines, routing between data sources, memory/state and autonomous task execution.
- Sectors must be a core source: removing Sectors data should break the product's core functionality.
- Judging prioritizes real-world usability (40%), demo/storytelling (30%) and technical depth/execution (30%).

2. Problem Validation: What Marketers Are Complaining About

The project idea is based on an existing workflow problem rather than inventing a new behavior. Recent marketing discussions repeatedly surface the same pain points.

Observed pain	Evidence from marketers	Why it matters	RivalPulse response
Too many competitors	A product marketer described maintaining a spreadsheet of around 20 regular competitors while also owning SEO, events, customer marketing and other work.	Tracking becomes a maintenance burden instead of a strategic capability.	Persistent watchlists + automated refresh.
Hours of recurring manual work	A marketer reported spending 2-3 hours per week on Google Alerts, social checks and spreadsheet updates for pricing, features and content themes.	Time is spent collecting data instead of interpreting it.	Agent collects and structures evidence before analysis.
Missing important changes	B2B marketers describe manual site checking as time-consuming and worry they are missing significant updates.	The worst signal may arrive from a customer or sales rep after the market has already moved.	Signal filtering + severity + change history.
Tools can be noisy or expensive	Marketers report monitoring tools that are too expensive, generate false alerts or are difficult to integrate.	More alerts are not automatically better intelligence.	Evidence-backed alerts only when a threshold is met.
Collection is the bottleneck	Growth marketers say AI helps with analysis, but collection and verification still consume time.	A useful agent needs tools and data pipelines, not only prompting.	Custom tool pipeline + Sectors + public sources.
Raw change does not equal strategy	Recent discussions emphasize that noticing a changed pricing page is easy; understanding strategic meaning is the harder work.	Teams need context, not a diff feed.	Financial context + agent interpretation + explicit facts vs hypotheses.

Problem statement

Marketing and strategy teams waste time manually tracking competitors across fragmented sources, while the financial context that could explain those competitive moves remains difficult to connect and interpret.

Important positioning: Competitive-intelligence tools already exist. The innovation claim should be narrower: RivalPulse combines Indonesian public-company competitive monitoring, persistent agent state and Sectors financial context in a purpose-built workflow. Do not claim nobody has ever built competitor monitoring before.

3. The Solution: RivalPulse

Target user: product marketing managers, corporate strategy teams, business development teams, startup founders and research teams that need to monitor Indonesian public-company competitors without becoming equity analysts.

Core user story

"I monitor TLKM, ISAT and EXCL. Show me the competitive changes that actually matter, support them with evidence, and explain what the signals could mean for our marketing or strategy."

What the agent does

1	Understand the brief - Identify the user company, monitored competitors, industry and research objective.
2	Plan required evidence - Decide which Sectors endpoints and external signals are required before answering.
3	Retrieve financial context - Fetch company profiles, industry data, financial performance, rankings/growth and relevant company news through Sectors v2 where applicable.
4	Collect public competitive signals - Gather selected public changes such as product/pricing pages, announcements, partnerships or campaign signals through permitted sources.
5	Compare against stored state - Determine what is genuinely new, materially changed or unusual versus the previous research state.
6	Score and explain - Assign severity, present the facts, explain business context, and separate AI hypotheses from verified evidence.
7	Store the result - Persist research history so the next run can reason over change rather than starting from zero.

Critical output rule: facts vs hypotheses

FACT	"Revenue increased 12.8% YoY." Source-backed and directly verifiable.
OBSERVED SIGNAL	"The company announced a new distribution partnership." Source-backed public event.

AI HYPOTHESIS	“The combination may indicate a stronger market-share push.” Clearly labeled interpretation, never presented as fact.
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4. System Architecture

Keep the architecture purposeful. The goal is not to win with the most infrastructure; it is to make the end-to-end workflow reliable, explainable and demoable.



Why Sectors is core

RivalPulse should become substantially less useful if Sectors is removed. The financial context is what turns a generic website-change monitor into a strategic intelligence tool for Indonesian public companies.

- Company and industry discovery: map monitored firms to comparable peers and industry context.
- Financial performance: add growth, profitability and other company metrics to competitive signals.
- Market/industry context: determine whether a company movement is company-specific or part of a broader industry trend.
- Relevant news and company data: enrich signal investigation using Sectors v2 capabilities.
- API credit efficiency: use Redis or database caching and refresh policies so the team does not waste the 1,000 hackathon API credits.

Example backend entities

WATCHLIST	SIGNAL	RESEARCH_RUN
team_id	company	query
company_ticker	type	plan
industry	detected_at	tool_calls
active	severity	summary
	evidence	created_at
	financial_context	

5. MVP Scope: What You Should Actually Build

Do not build the entire startup. Build one convincing workflow end-to-end and make the demo excellent.

Must-have

- ✓ **Company watchlist:** User selects 2-5 Indonesian public-company competitors.
- ✓ **Research command:** User asks a competitive question or presses “Investigate”.
- ✓ **Agent plan:** UI exposes a simple progress trail: identify companies -> fetch Sectors data -> gather signals -> compare -> explain.
- ✓ **Sectors-backed context:** At least 2-3 meaningful Sectors data calls are used in the final analysis.
- ✓ **Signal card:** Each result shows severity, evidence, financial context and “why marketing should care”.
- ✓ **Persistent state:** Store previous run/signal so a second demo run can show “new since last check”.
- ✓ **Evidence discipline:** Every claim is labeled as fact, observed signal or AI hypothesis.
- ✓ **Disclaimer:** Information/analysis only; no investment recommendation or automated trade execution.

Nice-to-have only if the MVP is stable

- Scheduled monitoring
- Slack/email notification
- Competitor discovery suggestions
- Multiple research templates
- Exportable battlecard/PDF
- Authentication and multi-team workspace
- Advanced charts
- Cloud observability dashboard

Do NOT spend the hackathon on

Kubernetes, Kafka, ten microservices, a giant scraper fleet, complex role-based access control or a perfect design system. These are useful in real products, but they can destroy the time available for usability and demo quality.

Suggested demo scenario

Example: Telecom competitive intelligence

- User chooses TLKM, ISAT and EXCL.
- RivalPulse fetches Sectors data and recent selected public signals.
- Agent detects one meaningful competitive change.
- Dashboard shows evidence, financial momentum and strategic interpretation.
- User clicks Investigate for a deeper agent run.
- A second run demonstrates memory: “new since previous check.”

6. Team of Four: Recommended Roles

Each member should own a subsystem. Collaboration is expected, but clear ownership prevents four people from editing the same feature while another critical part remains unfinished.

Role	Primary owner	Responsibilities	Definition of done
Frontend & UX Lead	Your frontend-strong friend	Next.js UI; dashboard; charts; loading/progress states; signal cards; responsive demo flow; front-end integration.	A judge can understand the product without explanation and complete the main workflow smoothly.
Backend / Platform Lead	You	API design; Sectors integration; database; Redis/cache; Docker; environment variables; deployment; logging; integration contracts.	Stable endpoints power the complete demo; Sectors calls are cached and reproducible; app runs from a clean setup.
AI Agent Engineer	Friend 2	Planner; tool schemas; orchestration; prompts; evidence format; fact/hypothesis separation; state-aware reasoning; failure handling.	Agent does multiple purposeful steps, calls tools correctly and produces grounded structured output.
Research / Data / Product Engineer	Friend 3	Problem research; public signal sources; competitor dataset; evaluation cases; product requirements; QA; demo script and narrative.	Demo uses believable data, claims are validated, edge cases are tested and the pitch clearly explains the real problem.

How the team should collaborate

- Agree on the JSON response format on day one. Frontend and AI work can then proceed in parallel against mocked responses.
- Backend owns the tool interfaces. Agent engineer consumes stable functions such as `get_company_metrics()`, `get_industry_context()` and `get_recent_signals()`.
- Research/Product prepares 3-5 fixed demo cases early. Do not wait until the last day to discover that the selected company has weak data coverage.
- Every day, merge to a runnable main branch. A hackathon demo should never depend on one teammate's laptop.

Suggested delivery ownership

Deliverable	Owner	Support
Working product	Backend / Platform	Frontend + Agent
3-minute judging video	Research / Product	Everyone
Public repository / README	Backend / Platform	Everyone
One-minute teaser + social post	Frontend / UX	Research / Product

7. Build Plan and Pitch Strategy

Recommended build sequence

Phase 1 - Contract & mock - Freeze the main use case, data model, endpoint contract and Figma/simple UI. Mock the final agent JSON immediately.

Phase 2 - Sectors integration - Make real Sectors v2 calls, normalize responses, cache them and validate data coverage for the demo companies.

Phase 3 - Agent orchestration - Connect planner + tools + structured output. Add explicit provenance and fact/hypothesis labels.

Phase 4 - State & signals - Persist watchlists, prior analyses and change detection. Add severity logic.

Phase 5 - UX & reliability - Polish the demo path, loading/progress states, errors and response readability.

Phase 6 - Storytelling - Record a clear before/after workflow: manual pain -> agent working -> evidence-backed result -> why it matters.

Three-minute judging video structure

0:00-0:25	Problem: competitive research is fragmented, manual and easy to miss.
0:25-0:40	Who it is for: marketing / product marketing / strategy teams monitoring Indonesian competitors.
0:40-1:55	Live workflow: watchlist -> agent plan -> Sectors calls -> signal -> strategic explanation.
1:55-2:25	Technical depth: orchestration, tool routing, state/memory, caching and fact/hypothesis discipline.
2:25-2:45	Why Sectors is essential: financial context transforms raw changes into business intelligence.
2:45-3:00	Close: one-line value proposition and disclaimer.

Suggested pitch

“RivalPulse is an AI competitive-intelligence agent that monitors Indonesian companies and connects competitive activity with verified financial signals, helping marketing and strategy teams understand not just what competitors are doing, but why it may matter.”

Safety / compliance positioning

RivalPulse is an information and analysis product. It must not provide financial advice, recommend buying/selling securities or execute trades. The UI should include a clear disclaimer and phrase outputs as competitive/business analysis.

8. Research Sources & Hackathon References

Sources reviewed for the concept brief. Community discussions are qualitative evidence of recurring pain, not statistically representative market surveys.

1. Sectors Hackathon 2026 - Official Rules

Team size, Sectors-core requirement, deadlines, judging weights, submission requirements and financial-advice restriction. [Open source](#)

2. Sectors Hackathon - AI Agents & Assistants

Requires an AI/LLM component and custom-built agent logic/orchestration; examples include multi-step reasoning, tool use, routing, memory/state and autonomous execution. [Open source](#)

3. Sectors Financial API v2 - Overview

Current recommended Sectors Financial API; Indonesian financial-market data and analysis workflows. [Open source](#)

4. Sectors Financial API v2 - Changelog

Documents enhanced company filtering, growth analytics and unified news capabilities. [Open source](#)

5. Reddit / r/DigitalMarketing - “Competitor tracking is becoming a pain” (Aug 2026)

Product marketer describes maintaining ~20 competitors while also owning many other marketing responsibilities. [Open source](#)

6. Reddit / r/AskMarketing - “How do you do competitor intelligence?” (Jun 2026)

Marketer describes 2-3 hours/week of alerts, social checks and spreadsheet tracking; manual work becomes tedious. [Open source](#)

7. Reddit / r/b2bmarketing - “What tools do you use for competitive intelligence & monitoring?” (Mar 2026)

Manual website monitoring is described as time-consuming; concerns include missed updates, expensive tools, false alerts and integration difficulty. [Open source](#)

8. Reddit / r/growthmarketing - “Does competitor research still take you longer than expected?” (Aug 2026)

Discussion emphasizes that data collection and verification can remain slower than the analysis itself. [Open source](#)

9. Reddit / r/b2bmarketing - “How much time do you ACTUALLY spend on competitive research every week?” (Jan 2026)

Discussion highlights missed important changes, noisy monitoring and the distinction between detecting a change and understanding strategic meaning. [Open source](#)

Current event facts used in planning

- Teams may contain 1-4 participants; this team of four is eligible.
- Each registered team receives 1,000 Sectors API credits after all members complete onboarding.
- Registration closes 22 September 2026 at 23:59 WIB; submissions close 30 September 2026 at 23:59 WIB.
- A public repository, one-minute teaser, judging video up to three minutes, one-sentence problem statement, track/team information and a social-media post are required.
- Real-world usability is the largest judging component at 40%.

RIVALPULSE / BUILD THE WORKFLOW, NOT JUST THE CHATBOT